

RASHAY DAYA

DEVOPS ENGINEER & FULL STACK BUILDER // CAPE TOWN, SOUTH AFRICA

rashay.jcdaya@gmail.com +27 83 668 1148 rashaydaya.co.za github.com/Rashay01
linkedin.com/in/rashay-daya-795804262

DevOps engineer on Sanlam Fintech's Platform Engineering team. I look after the shared Terraform estate that ten product teams build on, keep the security scanning and release tooling running, and pick up production incidents when they land. The part of the job I like most is when something I built gets used without me noticing. I came to it through a BSc at Wits (Dean's List, first-team hockey, a lot of time in the sound booth) and the Sanlam graduate programme, and I still read about data science and AI for fun. Outside work I ship full-stack platforms for real clients and maintain open-source DevOps tooling under Kaji Labs. Member of IITPSA and Golden Key.

FinLead Award winner DECEMBER 2025 · INNOVATION (JUGAAD)

Sanlam Fintech's award for living the Leadership Principles through 2025, won in my first year. Cited for finding a way where others saw a blocker: the stack naming pattern that made sandbox deploys safe, an Excel-driven E2E test generator anyone can use, the first AI Terraform Skills, and a state-unlock pipeline that stopped teams hand-editing Terraform state.

> EXPERIENCE

Junior DevOps Engineer · Platform Engineering, Sanlam Fintech JUL 2025 - PRESENT

- Own the shared Terraform estate eight product teams build on: grew it from 26 to 58 modules (tf-dynamodb alone has 37 dependent repos) and built the module index, versioning and release tooling it runs on.
- Wrote the RDS, ALB/WAF and Fargate modules, then combined them into the blueprint that stood up the SFTx-Hire application end to end.
- Run estate-wide upgrade sweeps that keep all 55+ repos on the latest tooling, the largest done in a day.
- Published the scaffold template that lets any org bootstrap GitHub OIDC roles instead of hand-rolling trust policies.
- Co-built the SPE Security Tooling Dashboard: one SBOM view across 17 GitHub organisations.
- Made IaC and container security scanning a required standard, enforced by a daily compliance Lambda, with per-team Slack reporting. Helped one team clear 900+ vulnerabilities.
- Created the AI Terraform Skills that audit every module against SFT standards and draw its architecture diagram; v1.0.0 shipped September 2026.
- Resolved 6 production incidents on-call, including rotating a compromised payments API key the day it surfaced.
- Presented twice at the DevOps Community of Practice and coached engineers across four teams, one from clickops to running his own Terraform deploys.

Graduate · Sanlam Data & Digital Academy, Sanlam Group Technology JAN 2024 - JUN 2025

- Final placement, SFT Platform Engineering (2025): co-developed the first 26 reusable Terraform modules (tf-cloudflare, tf-sns, tf-iam, tf-lambda among them), 2 blueprints, 2 scaffold templates and a reusable AWS IAM policy library. This estate carried Digisure's migration to pre-production and MultiPay Collections to production.
- Co-created the complete stack naming pattern (stack, project, version, developer) so developers deploy isolated sandbox stacks without colliding with shared resources. Introduced DR tagging across the modules.
- Put Digisure's API Swagger docs onto Cloudflare Pages so they rebuild on every deploy, and started an Excel-driven E2E test generator for Capstone so non-technical users can write and verify tests.
- Co-presented at the DevOps Community of Practice on reusable modules and the Units of Deployment strategy: splitting mono-repos into per-service repositories, which Digisure then adopted.
- Rotations: MS Chapter (full-stack on the Advice Partner app, React TypeScript, Redux, C#); SGT DBA (backups, alert automation, SAP Hana, SQL Server, MariaDB, PowerShell); SGT Solution Architecture (GitHub Actions research, Sanlam Connect diagrams).
- Hackathon: turned an existing email marketing flow into personalised WhatsApp messages with Python, React and the OpenAI API.

Technical Test Analyst · FNB, POP IT Quality Assurance JUL - DEC 2023

- Wrote and ran automated test cases in Java and Appium for FNB's new Enterprise Telling System.

> EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science & Computational Applications · University of the Witwatersrand 2020 - 2022

- Majors in Computer Science and Computational Applications. Dean's List 2021.
- Courses passed include Software Design, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Parallel Computing, Machine Learning, Computer Graphics, Advanced Algorithms, Formal Languages, Mobile Computing, Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus, Mathematical Statistics.

> PROJECTS, SHIPPED

Event RSVP & media platform - live full-stack platform with guest validation, RSVP flows and media uploads; 200+ guest records. marrying-maharaj.co.za

REACT · FIREBASE · CLOUDFLARE R2 · NODE.JS

The House of Chai - production web platform for a hospitality brand, frontend to deployment, 1m 28s build. thehouseofchai.co.za

REACT · NODE.JS · CLOUDFLARE PAGES · RAILWAY

PR Version Bot (Kaji Labs, open source) - GitHub Action that bumps semver, updates the changelog, tags and publishes a release from a single label on a merged PR. github.com/kaji-labs/pr-version-bot

GITHUB ACTIONS · BASH · SEMVER

Sanlam Platinum Plus - web-based insurance policy management system for luxury and high-value items: user registration, policy and claim management.

PYTHON · FLASK · JINJA · SQL SERVER · HTML · CSS

AI marketing hackathon (Sanlam, 2024) - turned an existing email marketing flow into personalised WhatsApp messages.

PYTHON · REACT · OPENAI API

Zen Marker - Android app for lecturers to load and mark assignments, with student groups per assignment.

ANDROID STUDIO · JAVA · MYSQL

Swap Shop - Android app for users to swap items with each other.

ANDROID STUDIO · JAVA · FIREBASE

Student Support website - online help and guidance for university students. Also: ZOMARCHY, a 3D zombie shooter in Three.js, and an online grocery app in Delphi. All on github.com/Rashay01.

REACT · JAVASCRIPT · HTML

> SKILLS

CLOUD & INFRA	AWS (Lambda, CloudFront, S3, ECS Fargate, RDS, WAF, Cognito), Terraform, Cloudflare, Docker, Linux, Railway
CI/CD & SECURITY	GitHub Actions, composite actions, Bash, PowerShell, Trivy, Gitleaks, GHAS, SBOM, OIDC, semantic versioning
LANGUAGES	Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C#, C, C++, SQL, HCL, Delphi, HTML, CSS
WEB	React, Next.js, Node.js, REST APIs, Tailwind, Three.js, Flask
DATABASES	Firebase, MySQL, SQL Server, SAP Hana, MariaDB, MS Access
AI TOOLING	Claude Code skills and agents, MCP, OpenAI API, AI-driven IaC auditing
TOOLS	Datadog, CloudWatch, Slack workflows, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Codecov, Git, Android Studio, Visual Studio
STRENGTHS	Problem solving, mathematics, data analysis, technical writing, communication, leadership, teamwork

> AWARDS AND HONOURS

- FinLead Award for Innovation (Jugaad), Sanlam Fintech, December 2025
- Sanlam Data & Digital Academy award for completing the academy, January 2025
- Dean's List, University of the Witwatersrand, 2021
- Golden Key International Honour Society, top 15% of achievers, 2021

> SDDA TRAINING MODULES

- Cloud on AWS; DevOps using AWS and Jenkins
- Python; Databases; JavaScript and React
- Machine Learning and AI
- Business and Process Analysis; Consumer Experience (CX)
- Enterprise Architecture; Agile Fundamentals; Presentation Skills

> COMMUNITIES

- Member, Institute of Information Technology Professionals of South Africa (IITPSA)
- Member, Golden Key International Honour Society
- Presenter, Sanlam Fintech DevOps Community of Practice, 2025 and 2026
- Founder and maintainer, Kaji Labs open-source DevOps tooling
- Community service: taught maths and arts & crafts to learners, 2018-19

> CERTIFICATIONS

- Selenium 4 WebDriver with Java (Basics, Advanced, Architect), Udemy
- Foundational C# with Microsoft, freeCodeCamp
- Discovering Ethical AI, Udacity
- Get the Most out of Confluence, Atlassian University
- Sage Pastel Accounting certificate, 2019
- First Aid course certificate, 2018

> OFF THE CLOCK

Before the terminal there was a mixing desk: three years cutting music for dance competitions is where the habit of getting the timing exactly right comes from. I still like explaining things more than I probably should, which is how I ended up presenting at the CoP twice. Data science and machine learning are what I read for fun, side projects occasionally turn into real client sites, and I speak English and Afrikaans. Still can't leave a repo without a README.